We finish this chapter by showing you the range of possible data governance automation levels. After reading this chapter, you will be able to do the following:

- Design the structure of data governance and define expected deliverables
- Split responsibilities among data governance actors
- Design automation of policy enforcement

Let's start by presenting a general overview of data governance.

6.1 Data governance in a nutshell

Before continuing, we must warn you that data governance is a vast concept, with many often incompatible implementations and interpretations. We describe some of these extremes in section 6.4.1. Here is the general definition we compiled for this book.

DEFINITION *Data governance* is a collection of information-related processes, roles (with a strong emphasis on decision rights and accountabilities), policies, standards, and metrics oriented to maximize the effectiveness of deriving business value from data.

As you can see, data governance describes an environment in which data can be transformed into information, information to knowledge, and so on, up to the business value.

The first and most important point to understand about data governance is that it's a continuous process, not a state. Putting it in motion may be a project, but it needs to become the modus operandi of the company data environment to be effective.

DEFINITION According to the *Data Management Body of Knowledge* (www.dama.org/cpages/body-of-knowledge), data governance is one of 11 data management knowledge areas. *Data management* deals with all aspects of data handling, from acquisition to architectures to policies. We need to be careful not to expect data governance results belonging to other areas of data management.